Touch of Water

Memory-Mapping with AR and Sound Journal

MMU Workshop · 24 June 2026 · 2:00pm–6:00pm · Bin Youn (AR) & Sigisora: Van Luber Parensen & Dyah Nindyasari (Sound Journal) & Suk-Jun Kim (Workshop Coordinator)

SYNOPSIS

Touch of Water: Memory-Mapping with AR and Sound Journal is a half-day collaborative workshop that uses the MMU campus as a site for exploring personal and collective memories of water. Participants work in small teams to produce two interlocking outputs: a location-responsive WebAR memory map and a sound journal, integrated into a single shareable digital experience.

Drawing directly from Loc (Filter · Strain · Purify, 2026), a site-specific WebAR installation by Bin Youn developed for the Te Canal in Ho Chi Minh City, the AR component uses photographed objects from archives and on site, converts them into 3D digital models using AI, and places them in a markerless AR space navigated by touch. GPS coordinates and bilingual text fragments function as a poetic layer. The camera feed is filtered to render the world alien, blue-shifted, seen as if through a membrane. The work treats the phone screen not as a window but as a filter: the body as a primary sensing instrument before the device.

This workshop adds an auditory dimension to the AR component using sound journal, a listening method of documenting and sharing the conditions through which listening occurs and providing contexts recording alone may not be able to capture. A team of Sigisora, a Jakarta-based listening initiative, introduces how they use sound journal as a listening method and examine how our personal and collective water memory is shaped by a politics of attention, that is to say, the orientation of the personal, social, infrastructural. Using field recordings and in-situ soundscape listening-composition, the sound journal forms the audio layer that accompanies the AR visual experience. The final integration of AR and sound is the work each team presents.

Water here is not a metaphor. It is the material, the method, and the memory.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of the workshop, participants will be able to:

1. Apply site-specific observation methods to collect sensory material for AR and sound-based work
2. Translate found objects into 3D digital models using AI-based photogrammetry tools
3. Construct a functional WebAR experience using a provided template, incorporating participant-generated assets, GPS data, and text
4. Practice field recording techniques and compose a series of sound journals from collected material
5. Integrate visual AR and audio elements into a unified, site-responsive digital experience
6. Critically reflect on how personal and collective water memories are encoded, filtered, and transmitted.

PROMPTS

These are not instructions. Hold them lightly as you move through the campus. Let them surface when useful, or resist them.

- What does water remember on this campus?
- Where does water leave its trace here? What residue does it leave behind?
- What sounds does water make here that it does not make elsewhere?
- Where are you and *who* are you when you record (collect) image and sound materials?
- Can a screen filter the way water filters?
- What is the difference between a photograph of water and the sound of water?
- What would it mean for this site to be seen through water's eyes and ears?
- Who and what else is watching/seeing and listening/hearing with you?
- Your body is approximately 60% water. What does that mean for how you sense this space?
- What would you preserve? What would you let dissolve?

GROUP STRUCTURE

12-20 participants are divided into 3-4 teams of 4-5 people. Each team has two tracks that work in parallel during the field and production phases.

AR Track (2-3 people per team)

Site photography, 3D model generation, AR template customisation, GPS and text layer, visual integration.

Sound Track (2-3 people per team)

Field recording, environmental listening, soundscape composition, sound journal documentation.

In the integration phase, both tracks combine to assemble the final output. No track is subordinate to the other. The integration is the work.

DETAILED SCHEDULE

1:00pm – 5:30pm

Time	Activity	PAP Phase
1:00-1:20	Introduction to workshop; presentation (Loc: Bin Youn; Sound Journal: Sigisora)	
1:20-1:40	Team formation · Role assignment · Site map orientation (Roopesh)	
1:40-3:00	Tool orientation & Field Phase: campus site visit (garden, water features, pool surroundings)	**Field Excavation**
3:00–4:20	Production Phase: AR Track builds WebAR experience · Sound Track edits soundscape	**Memory-Mapping**
4:20–5:00	Integration Phase: embed sound in AR scene, test on devices, finalise text layer	**Memory-Mapping**
5:00–5:30	Group sharing and critical reflection	

Field Phase Detail

AR Track

- Walk the designated campus water sites (garden, water features, pool surroundings)
- Photograph 3-5 objects associated with water: debris, surfaces, containers, edges, reflections
- Note GPS coordinates of key locations
- Write 8-12 short text fragments: bilingual if possible, drawn from what you see, touch, and smell
- Document the site as found -- do not clean up your observations

Sound Track

- Field record at minimum 3 distinct campus locations
- Record ambient water sounds (running, still, dripping, distant)
- Record non-water sounds that are entangled with water at each site
- Keep a written listening log: timestamp, location, what you heard, what surprised you
- Capture at least one recording of silence near water

Production Phase Detail

AR Track

- Upload selected photographs to Meshy AI
- Generate 3D models: choose from 4 candidate outputs per image based on texture fidelity and material character
- Export as GLB files
- Open the provided Loc workshop template (forked from github.com/binyoun/loc)
- Replace the three placeholder models with your team's GLB files
- Update GPS coordinates and poem/text fragments in the template
- Test on device

Sound Track

- Review and select recordings
- Edit to 3-5 minutes total: three sections, one per site, with transitions
- The soundscape should have a beginning, a middle, and an end, but not necessarily a narrative
- Export as a single MP3 or WAV file
- Write a brief listening note (5-7 sentences): what the soundscape holds, what it does not

Integration Phase Detail

- Embed the team's soundscape into the A-Frame WebAR scene using the <a-sound> component (guided step provided in template)
- The sound plays when participants open the AR experience
- Test the integrated experience together on multiple devices

- Adjust volume, trigger timing, or placement if needed
- Finalise the text/poem layer
- Deploy to GitHub Pages (or use instructor-hosted URL)

OUTPUTS

Each team produces:

- **WebAR Memory Map:** A functional WebAR experience accessible via browser URL. Contains: three site-specific 3D objects, GPS coordinates as text layer, a bilingual or multilingual poem/fragment pool, camera filter treatment, and integrated soundscape audio.
- **Sound Journal:** A composed soundscape of 3-5 minutes from campus field recordings, with a written listening note.
- **Brief Reflection (one page):** The water memory the team chose to work with, one decision about what to keep or remove, and what the integration of AR and sound revealed or failed to reveal.
- **Optional collective output:** A shared landing page linking all team URLs and sound journals, made available to all participants after the workshop.

PREREQUISITES

For AR

- Smartphone or tablet with a modern browser (Chrome recommended)
- GitHub account (free) -- create one before the workshop
- No coding experience required: the template is pre-built; participants replace assets and text only
- Openness to AI-assisted 3D model generation as a creative tool, not just a technical pipeline

For Sound Journal

- No prior audio recording experience required
- Bring headphones (over-ear preferred, any type works)
- Download Audacity (free, desktop) before the workshop, or bring a mobile recording app
- Willingness to be slow in the field: listening requires duration

MATERIALS AND RESOURCES

For AR

Item	Source / Notes
Workshop WebAR template (fork of Loc)	Provided by Bin Youn at start of workshop · binyoun.github.io/loc
Meshy AI (image-to-3D generation)	meshy.ai · free tier sufficient (test accounts pre-registered)
A-Frame documentation	aframe.io
GitHub Pages	github.com/pages · for deployment
Smartphones or tablets	Participants' own devices

For Sound Journal

Item	Source / Notes
Portable digital recorders	Zoom H1n or equivalent · MMU film school equipment depot (Roopesh to confirm)
Over-ear headphones	Equipment depot or participants' own
Audacity (audio editing)	Free download, desktop · audacityteam.org
Field recording handout	Provided by Suk-Jun Kim at start of workshop
Sound journal log sheet	Provided in workshop packet

LEARNING MATERIALS

Conceptual References

- Loc (Filter · Strain · Purify), Bin Youn, 2026. WebAR installation, Kenh Te Canal, Ho Chi Minh City. Fabric Narratives, 28th IFFTI, RMIT University Vietnam. binyoun.github.io/loc
- Present Archaeology Pedagogy (PAP), Bin Youn & collaborators, 2026. binyoun.github.io/mnode/
- Sigisora Sound Journals https://www.instagram.com/p/DXbAObRjbPN/ https://www.instagram.com/p/DIaPHwQN2Ra/ https://www.instagram.com/p/DXbFo6ojSIv/
- Truax, B. (2008). Soundscape Composition as Global Music: Electroacoustic music as soundscape. Organised Sound : An International Journal of Music Technology, 13(2), 103–109. https://doi.org/10.1017/S1355771808000149
- Anderson I, Rennie T. Thoughts in the Field: 'Self-reflexive narrative' in field recording. Organised Sound. 2016;21(3):222-232. doi:10.1017/S1355771816000194

Technical References: AR

- A-Frame Getting Started Guide (distributed as PDF)
- Meshy AI image-to-3D walkthrough (step-by-step handout provided)
- GitHub Pages deployment guide (step-by-step handout provided)
- Loc annotated source code (key sections commented for workshop use)

Technical References: Sound

- Zoom H1n quick-start card
- Audacity beginner tutorial (link distributed before workshop)